



Amazon on PlayStation 3

The Amazon Instant Video app will be available to PS3 console users, with over 120,000 movies and TV shows for users to purchase and rent <http://dgit.in/IyHyFr>

Did you know?

Among Facebook users, 38 percent share negative information in their status updates, according to a Gothenburg statement

Feature

T-series is looking for actors for its next movie on YouTube.

Trying to emulate the success of Kickstarter, we have Rang De, a non-profit that gives the economically weak a platform to borrow money to execute their entrepreneurial ideas. The non-profit's end goal is to reduce poverty in India.

With internet connectivity gradually penetrating villages in India, crowdsourced projects that don't require a lot of knowledge would prove to be a hit in these places.

What's next?

Some new avenues for crowdsourcing includes the following: The U.S. Military is experimenting with crowdsourced approaches to design vehicles. The Reddit community tried drafting its own legislation, dubbed the "Free Internet Act," protesting anti-piracy laws like SOPA and PIPA. YouTube organised a project named "Life in a day" to make a documentary based on people's daily lives.

Another ambitious crowdsourced project was Meshnet, the name given to an alternative version of the internet, that certain users on Reddit wanted to build, free of government control or any sort of censorship.

People on the internet want to be a part of something big, want to make a difference and not just share pictures of cats. This is why ambitious crowdsourcing projects gather appeal and participation.

Challenges to crowdsourcing

Of course, along with traditional institutions, even the "crowd" on the internet needs to mature. There have been various instances in which a group of people on the internet ganged up with a mob like mentality, often for a legitimate cause, but end up doing more harm than good by adopting unlawful ways.

The internet community still needs to figure out a way to deal with trolls. Till now the solution's been to strike a balance between the "openness" and the control, but it's far from ideal.

Another problem that plagues many crowdsourced information gathering attempts is accuracy of information. A survey, for example, has no concrete way of ensuring that the data being entered by a person is accurate. A large sample space would, however, minimise this "noise," unless, of course, you're up against the most notorious forum on the internet, 4chan. The hacker collective "Anonymous", regulars at the 4chan forums, decided to "precision hack" the 2009 Time Person of the Year Poll to declare the founder of 4chan a winner. Read more about the Time Person of the Year Poll hack: <http://dgit.in/Inucx3>

The big picture

The low barrier of entry to the web has catalyzed crowdsourcing and given it a much-needed shot in the arm. With added interest and growing participation, we can actually hope to make a difference. Crowdsourcing is definitely here to stay. 



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